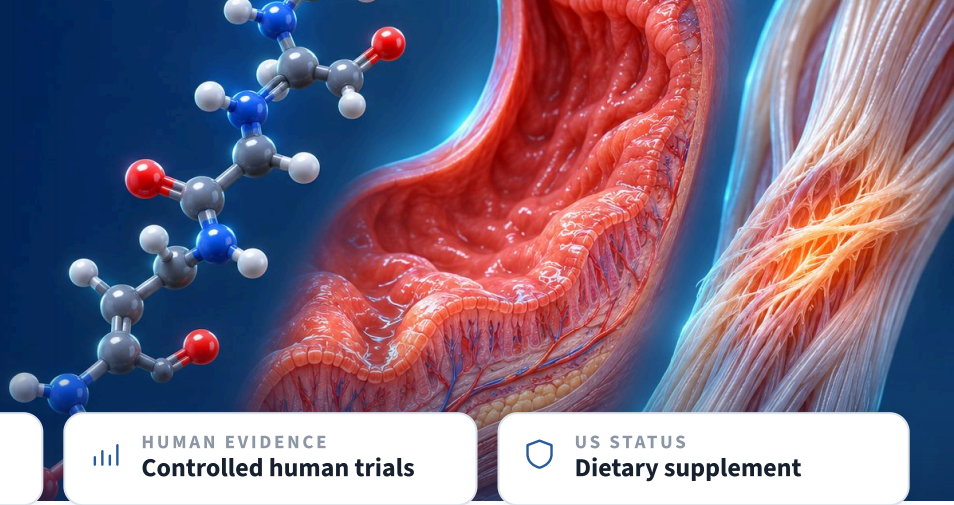
RECOVERY 05

Creatine

Compound the body makes and gets from meat and fish; stored mainly in muscle (supplement: monohydrate)



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Dietary supplement	Strength, lean mass	Controlled human trials	Dietary supplement

STUDIED FOR

Strength	Lean mass	Hormones
HUMAN	HUMAN	HUMAN

Not every trial found an effect. In men with prostate cancer on hormone therapy, lean mass and strength did not differ between creatine and placebo.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Creatine → Muscle stores up → Muscle energy → Strength studied

- **Stored mainly in skeletal muscle,** also heart, brain and testes
- **Supplements raise muscle creatine:** up 22% after one week in a 1999 trial
- **Broken down to creatinine,** which leaves in the urine
- **Muscle energy** role described in lab and animal studies

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

CONTROLLED TRIALS
LEVEL 4 OF 5

- Many small RCTs, mostly in men
- Meta-analysis: 23 trials in adults under 50
- Not developed or approved as a drug

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- DHT effect on hair or prostate

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established	By mouth (powder, drinks)
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Stored in muscle; excreted as creatinine in urine	Dietary supplement
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Strength, lean mass, muscle creatine	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Dietary supplement; not an approved drug
FDA	GRAS notice 931 for some foods: no questions
WADA	Not prohibited

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Response letter to GRAS Notice 931 (creatine monohydrate), Dec 2020
2. Volek et al., creatine in resistance-trained men, Med Sci Sports Exerc, Aug 1999
3. Wang et al., creatine and strength meta-analysis, Nutrients, Oct 2024

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